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Adult penalties continue for 18-year-olds

Legislation to try late teens as juveniles for certain crimes stalled on Beacon Hill

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

The wide-ranging economic development package passed last month was one of the last opportunities this year for bills idling on Beacon Hill to become law, and legislators attached everything from language clearing the way for a new soccer stadium in Everett to a long-sought measure to let candidates spend campaign funds on child care.

Left behind was legislation that would allow 18-year-olds to be tried and sentenced as juveniles instead

of adults for certain crimes, despite enjoying the strong support of one of the Legislature's most powerful figures.

It's not the first time criminal justice reform advocates backing the so-called "Raise The Age" proposal faced disappointment. In 2013, the Legislature lifted the age of juvenile jurisdiction to include 17-year-olds. But efforts to bump the age up again have stalled for more than a decade, even though it is a priority for state Senate President Karen E. Spilka.

That's left many young people subject to harsher penalties in the

adult system, where activists say reforming their behavior is more difficult.

"I don't think it's a priority for whoever's there — to me, it's like they don't really care because it doesn't impact them," said Kevin Keo, who was convicted of participating in a murder at 16 and now works with young people in the criminal justice system.

"Going in there meant having to learn fast really what it meant to be an adult. Seeing all the trauma it did to me and how horribly I transitioned, there was just no emotional growth at all," said Keo, now 33. Many of the young adults Keo works with "have so much trauma that a

YOUTHFUL DEFENDANTS, Page A7

'I don't think it's a priority for whoever's there — to me, it's like they don't really care because it doesn't impact them.'

KEVIN KEO, *who was convicted as an adult while in his teens and now works with troubled youth*

Israel pummels depots in Syria

Plans to bolster disputed Golan Heights occupation

By Vivian Yee
NEW YORK TIMES

CAIRO — Israel struck Syrian weapons depots and air defenses overnight, a group monitoring the conflict said Sunday, in an effort Israel says is aimed at depriving "extremists" of military assets after rebels seized power in Syria.

► **Rift over Gaza prompted Israel to close embassy in Ireland. A4.** In all, Israel struck its neighbor 75 times in attacks that began Saturday night near the Syrian capital, Damascus, and the cities of Hama and Homs, according to the group, the Syrian Observatory for Human Rights, a Britain-based organization that has long tracked the conflict in Syria. There were no immediate reports of casualties.

Israel has struck Syria more than 450 times since the collapse of the Assad regime a week ago, according to the Observatory, destroying Syria's navy and dozens of bases and ammunition depots.

Israel's military has also seized territory in Syria over the de facto border between the two countries, including on the Syrian side of the strategic Mount Hermon. Israel has given no timeline for its departure. The Associated Press reported Israel's government has approved Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's plan to send a military mission to the region.

MIDEAST, Page A5

Liberals voice skepticism with Kennedy

Share some views with him, but concerns abound

By Sam Brodey and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — Between Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s hard-line opposition to vaccines, staunch support of Donald Trump, and conspiratorial leanings on a number of subjects, it's easy to forget the commonalities he shares with Democratic senators in a way that no other Trump pick for Cabinet does.

As Kennedy begins his rounds on Capitol Hill this week to push his nomination as health and human services secretary, he brings with him a long record of liberal advocacy — from crusading against corporate conglomerates in the food and fossil fuel industries to decrying climate change and income inequality.

But he shouldn't expect a warm welcome from progressives, even if he sometimes sounds identical to many of them.

For some, Kennedy's shared beliefs merely offer a foot in the door. Others have already slammed that door altogether.

KENNEDY, Page A6



COURTESY OF NEIL MALICK

A SHELL OF AN INDUSTRY

Clam diggers in Boston area face 'end of an era' with closing of plant

By David Abel
GLOBE STAFF

GLOUCESTER — For nearly a century, Neil Malick's family hauled bushels of soft-shell clams from the mudflats around Boston Harbor to the state's purification plant on Plum Island, where the shellfish soaked for three days in large seawater tanks to purge their slimy mantles of any contaminants.

Late last year, a coastal storm battered the island and shuttered the century-old plant, leaving Malick and others who dig for clams in the state's "conditionally restricted" areas no easy way to cleanse their shellfish. The wells and pumps that supplied clean seawater to the plant had been destroyed. Later



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Clammers Neil Malick (left) and Kevin Boudreau stood at a purification plant on Plum Island. The two started digging clams for Neil's dad, Joe. At top, a crew of Joe Malick's dug through the flats of Houghs Neck in Quincy.

storms eroded surrounding dunes and inundated the plant's interior.

"We have too many years in this business to let it go," said Malick, 61, of Weymouth, who joined his family's shellfishing business in 1984.

Over the past year, Malick and other diggers have urged state officials to repair the plant, the only one of its kind in Massachusetts. Clams harvested from such restricted areas must be purified before they're sold to market.

On Friday, following a tense meeting last month with diggers, state officials decided to close the plant permanently.

"It's a really difficult situa-

CLAMMERS, Page A10

Lewiston still feels economic effects of shooting

A year after tragedy, many visitors to Maine city remain leery, but hope is stirring

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

LEWISTON, Maine — Peter Flanders was a little thrown by a customer's quiet question about his bar, but he knew exactly what it meant.

"Is there a back door?" the customer had asked.

A mass shooting in the city on Oct. 25, 2023, left 18 dead and 13 injured in a bowling alley and a bar near Flanders's two downtown restaurants, Sonder & Dram and bon Vivant. After the tragedy, people began to trickle back into the area's bars and eateries, but they had questions like that, about how to get away, how to stay safe. Some didn't want to sit with their back to the door. Others didn't want to return to such gathering places at all.

A year later, many still don't. Flanders said ZIP code data from credit cards used at his restaurants show that customers these days are mostly from the immediate area: Lewiston and its next-door sister city, Auburn. The restaurants, like many in central Maine, typically rely on people trekking into the downtown from the surrounding communities, but that business cratered by 80 to 90 percent, he estimated, resulting in a loss of more than \$200,000 for the conjoined restaurants. The same trend was reported by establishments on Lisbon Street, the main downtown thor-

LEWISTON, Page A7



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

Samantha Juray listed a promotion event at Just-In-Time Recreation, which she owns in Lewiston, Maine. It was one of two sites of a mass shooting a year ago.



Don we now our gray

Monday: Cloudy, rain late. High 41-46, low 37-42.

Tuesday: Cloudy, warmer. High 57-62, low 36-41.

High tide: 11:23 a.m.

Sunrise: 7:07. Sunset: 4:13.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C10.**

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Defamation lawsuits appeared to be among the tools of the incoming Trump administration to stifle unfavorable media coverage. A6.

The Patriots' 30-17 loss to the Cardinals was a game of missed opportunities. C1.

The impeachment of South Korea's president creates a political vacuum at the top of one of America's most-important allies. A4.

Students who were denied a high school diploma after failing MCAS tests now have a second chance at earning the potentially life-changing credential. B1.